B1+ LESSON 1





Being a Digital Citizen

Introduction

In this lesson Ss:

- reflect on the rights and responsibilities they have as 'digital citizens', i.e. members of various online communities, while discussing possible risks and dangers associated with the use of digital media and the internet.
- express their opinions on the need to (re)write an article of the Italian Constitution so as to make it suitable to include the use of the internet.
- use their creative skills to sensitise other people against hate speech and online discrimination.

STEP 1 RAISING AWARENESS

1 A Point to the photo and ask Ss to describe it. After that, ask them questions about their use of the internet and social media. *What do you mainly use the internet for? What do you use social media for? What are the advantages of being members of such large communities? And the disadvantages?* Then ask Ss to do the exercise and compare their answers in pairs. Briefly check answers as a class.

ANSWERS:

1 identity theft
2 fake profile
3 copyright
4 scam

B Put Ss into pairs and allow time for them to read and discuss the task. Monitor and help with vocabulary if needed. Elicit ideas from the class. They might include the following points:

Good digital citizens:

- use technologies in a responsible way.
- make correct and careful use of all spaces (chats) available in virtual communities and on social networks.
- navigate safely and recognise the dangers of the internet (scams or data theft).
- learn to protect their own privacy and respect that of others.

STEP 2 GOING AHEAD

2 A Tell Ss that they are going to read four different scenarios illustrating different traits of behaviours we may have as digital citizens. Allow them time to read in silence. When they have finished, put Ss into pairs and allow time for them to discuss the questions. Monitor and help with vocabulary if needed. Get feedback as a class, making sure Ss can justify their answers.

SUGGESTED ANSWERS:

Scenario 1 The students didn't behave in a responsible way as they should have cited their sources. As to the use of images, they should have checked the copyright rules.

Scenario 2 He should have asked his sister before using her card. And his sister shouldn't have shared her credit card password. Also worth mentioning: it is not always safe to use credit cards when buying online.

Scenario 3 Ss' own answer

Scenario 4 It is never safe to accept a friendship request from someone you don't know personally. There are fake profiles online.

B Focus Ss on the three elements of digital citizenship: internet safety, protection of personal information and personal conduct online. Ask Ss why they think these three elements are important when using the internet. Elicit their answers.

ANSWERS:

internet safety: scenario 4
protection of personal information: scenario 2
personal conduct online: scenarios 1–3

C Focus Ss on Question 1. Elicit whether the statement is true or false, or if the information is not given in the scenarios they have read. If they volunteer that the sentence is true or false, ask them to find the place in the text where it says so. They should not be able to find anything if the answer is not given in the text. Explain that they must decide if the rest of the statements are true, false or not given. Allow time for them to work individually and then compare answers with a partner. Get feedback as a class, making sure Ss can justify their answers.

ANSWERS:

1 F 'They copied and pasted texts on the slides, and added some pictures they found online, but without saying exactly where they found the information.'
2 F 'He has saved his pocket money, but he needs a credit card.'
3 T We know he has the credit card, but we aren't told how he got it.
4 T 'One day you see that someone has posted some very nasty comments about you and your friends under the picture.'
5 NG

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Language for citizenship

3 Allow time for Ss to read and discuss the words and phrases. Monitor and help with vocabulary as needed. Briefly check answers as a class. Ask them to give examples or reasons for their answers.

ANSWERS:

Digital rights	Digital responsibilities
have freedom of expression create and share digital media give credit for other people's work have access to computers and other devices ask for data protection	cite works and sources used in your texts keep personal information safe respect other people's privacy make meaningful contributions to the online community communicate respectfully, even when you disagree

CRITICAL THINKING

The Italian Constitution

4A Tell Ss they are going to read Article 21 of the Italian Constitution. When they have finished, elicit the meaning of the word *censura* and provide the English word for it (*censorship*). Get feedback as a class. After that you can ask for examples of situations in which 'the freedom of expression' is not respected.

ANSWERS:

1 Article 21 is about … the freedom of expression.

2 According to Article 21, censorship is … illegal.

B This question can be used to make Ss reflect on the need to update the Constitution or not ('ogni altro mezzo di diffusione' can include the internet or other means which may be invented in the future). Allow time for Ss to discuss the questions in small groups. Get feedback as a class, making sure they can justify their answers.

ANSWER:

The internet didn't exist in 1948 when the Constitution was approved.

STEP 3 TAKING ACTION

Digital literacies

5A/B Write *Manifesto of Non-hostile Communication* on the board. Elicit examples of hate speech and online hostile communication. Ask Ss, in English or L1, if they think such a Manifesto is needed. They use the internet to search for the text of the Manifesto. Divide Ss into small groups and allow time for them to read and discuss the rules. Monitor and help with the meaning of the rules.

Each group should choose a different rule to be illustrated through a different technique.

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